

The percentage of ever-married women aged 15 years and over who have never given live birth is 10.6 percent. Among ever-married women in Sri Lanka, the majority (33.3 percent) have given birth to two live children during their lifetime. When females residing in the Estate Rural sector are considered, the highest percentage have given birth to three live children. However, the percentage of ever-married females in the Estate Rural sector who have never had a live birth is 12.4 percent. The highest percentage of females who have given birth to only one child is in the Urban sector" which is 21.3 percent.

Figure 9.3, illustrates the percentage distribution of ever-married women aged 15 years and over by the number of live births per woman and by sector.

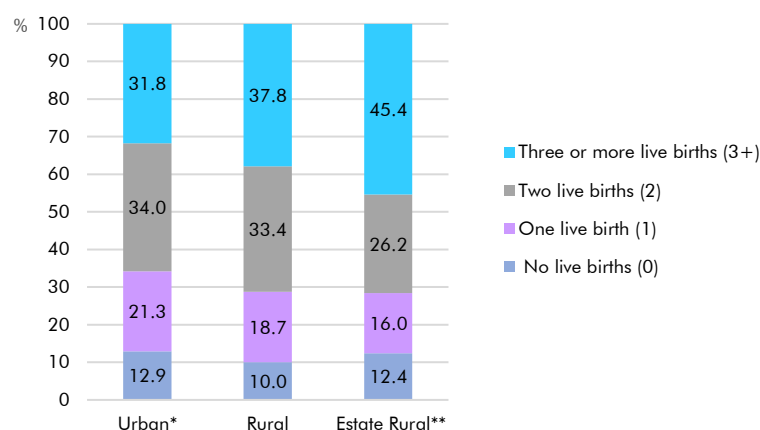


Figure 9.3 : Percentage Distribution of Ever-Married Women Aged 15 Years and Over by the Number of Live Births per Woman and Sector, 2024

* In 2024 information was collected separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, for comparison with the 2012 Census data, these two sectors have been combined and presented as "Urban".

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as "Estate", whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as "Estate Rural."

According to census data, among ever-married females in the Estate Rural sector, 45.4 out of every 100 have given birth to three or more children. In the rural sector, 37.8 out of every 100 ever-married females have had three or more children, while in the urban sector, the corresponding figure is 31.8 out of every 100 ever-married females.

The age distribution of currently married females of reproductive age (15–49 years), based on the Censuses of Population and Housing in 2012 and 2024, is shown in Table 9.13. Also, shows the percentage of married women to total women population aged 15-49.

Table 9.13 : Number and Percentage Distribution of Married Women Aged 15–49 Years by Age Group, 2012 and 2024

Age Group	2012		2024	
	Number	%	Number	%
15-19	85,392	2.4	30,199	0.9
20-24	335,158	9.3	198,888	5.9
25-29	598,450	16.7	438,683	12.9
30-34	734,555	20.4	635,307	18.7
35-39	646,905	18.0	682,347	20.1
40-44	617,503	17.2	741,533	21.8
45-49	574,175	16.0	672,196	19.8
Currently married women aged 15-49 years	3,592,138	100.0	3,399,153	100.0
All women aged 15-49 years	5,355,092		5,471,206	
Percentage married		67.1		62.1